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RESEARCH INTERESTS	Applied Microeconomics: Labor Economics Family Economics Health Economics	
EDUCATION	Ph.D. in Economics, University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Advisor: Donna Gilleskie Committee: Jane Fruehwirth, Luca Flabbi, Désiré Kédagni, Jacob Kohlhepp	Expected 2027
	M.A. in Applied Economics, University of North Carolina at Greensboro	2020
	M.Phil. in Economics, University of Ghana	2018
	B.A. in Economics and Statistics, University of Ghana	2015
JOB MARKET PAPER	<i>From Cradle to Consequence: The Dynamic Impact of Parental Behaviors on Teenage Outcomes Among Fragile Families.</i> [Link] Abstract: How do parental behaviors at different stages of childhood causally shape a child's long-run outcomes? This paper estimates the causal impacts of observed parental behaviors (marriage/cohabitation, employment, welfare receipt, substance use, and criminal activity) on cognitive ability, and teenage educational attainment, substance use, and criminal behavior among fragile families. I develop and jointly estimate a dynamic model of parental behaviors, child cognitive skill production, and teenage outcome production using the DFRE methodology and data from the Fragile Families and Child Wellbeing Study. The model accounts for permanent and time-varying family unobserved heterogeneity throughout, enabling credible causal identification. A key finding is that parental behaviors shape teenage outcomes primarily through direct behavioral pathways rather than through cognitive skill formation, suggesting that policies aimed solely at boosting cognitive test scores are unlikely to undo the long-run damage of adverse parental trajectories. Three policy experiments – a Sin-to-Skill tax, a marriage promotion policy, and a mandatory parental leave policy – illustrate that sustained, multi-dimensional interventions targeting early childhood offer the greatest potential for improving long-run child outcomes in fragile families.	
JOURNAL ARTICLES	- Kuperberg, A., Turkson, D., Mazelis, J.M., Fredricks, K., & Pant, A. (2025). Student Loan Debt and Higher Education Disruptions During COVID-19. <i>Journal of Student Financial Aid</i>, 54 (2): Article 8. [Link] - Yorke, F.R., Wahab, S., & Turkson, D. (2023). Maternal Education and Child Malnutrition: Evidence from West Africa. <i>SN Social Sciences</i>, 3 (200): 1-30. [Link] - Nyarkpoh, M.K., Turkson, D., & Buaka, E.S. (2023). Tax compliance in Ghana: does corruption and trust in the government matter? <i>SN Social Sciences</i>, 3 (155): 1-18. [Link] - Osei, K.B., & Turkson, D. (2022). Cash Transfer and Multidimensional Child Poverty: Evidence from Ghana. <i>International Journal of Social Economics</i>, 49 (5): 744-764. [Link] Turkson, D., Addai, N.B., Chowdhury, F., & Mohammed, F. (2021). Government Policies and Firm Performance in the COVID-19 Pandemic Era: A Sectoral Analysis. <i>SN Business Economics</i>, 1(12): 1-22. [Link] - Arthur, G.A. & Turkson, D. (2021). The Welfare Impact of Household Loans: An Analysis for Ghana. <i>Journal of Finance and Economics</i>, 9(2): 83-92. [Link] Turkson, D., & Ahiabor, J.K. (2020). Implication of Natal Care and Maternity Leave on Child Morbidity: Evidence from Ghana. <i>Global Journal of Health Science</i>, 12(9): 94-104. [Link] Turkson, D., & Codjoe, E.A. (2020). The Household Enterprise Sector in Ghana: Overview and Challenges. <i>International Journal of Business and Management</i>, 15(8): 140-151. [Link]	

WORKING PAPERS	1. Turkson, D. “<i>Under the Influence: Marijuana Legalization, Crime, and Father Well-Being in Fragile Families.</i>” [draft] 2. Turkson, D., Wahab, S., Yorke, F.R., & Akyena, S. “<i>The Causal Effects of Multidimensional School and Household Poverty on Student Achievement: An IV-Latent Class Analysis</i>” [draft] 3. Onyina, K. & Turkson, D. “<i>Cash Transfer and the Labor Supply of Vulnerable Households and Individuals: Does Household Indebtedness Matter? A Triple DiD Analysis</i>” [draft] 4. Turkson, D. “<i>Impact of Alcohol Use on Academic Performance Among College Students: The Case of Acute and Chronic Drinking</i>” [draft]
WORKS IN PROGRESS	“<i>Parental Substance Use, Incarceration, and Long-Run Educational Attainment of Children in Fragile Families</i>” “<i>Rural Hospitals Closures and Hospital Surge Capacity</i>” (with Tyler Malone)
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	UNC-Chapel Hill Instructor ECON101: Introduction to Economics Summer 23, Fall 23, Summer 24, Summer 25, Summer 26 Teaching Assistant ECON470: Econometrics Spring 2025 ECON440: Analysis of Public Finance Fall 2024 ECON410: Intermediate Microeconomics Fall 2022, Spring 2026 ECON101: Introduction to Economics Spring 2023 UNC-Greensboro Teaching Assistant ECON201: Principles of Microeconomics Fall 2020, Spring 2021 University of Ghana Teaching Assistant EPMP602: Microeconomics Fall 2018 ECON316: Applied Statistics for Economists Spring 2019 ECON315: Applied Mathematics for Economists Fall 2018 ECON443 & 444: Econometrics I & II Fall 2015, Spring 2016
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Consultant at Enterprise Analysis Unit, The World Bank Aug 2023 - Dec 2026 Researcher at UNC Sheps Center for Health Services Research Jun 2025 - Jan 2026 Research Assistant to Andrés Hincapié, UNC Chapel Hill Spring 2024 Research Assistant to Arielle Kuperberg, UNC Greensboro Summer 2021 Research Assistant to Jeremy Bray, UNC Greensboro 2019–2020
TECHNICAL REPORTS	Modeling Energy Consumption at UNC Greensboro II. (2021) <i>Green Fund Project</i> (with Addai, N.B., Sturdivant J., Holland S., & Queen W.) [Link] Modeling Energy Consumption at UNC Greensboro. (2020) <i>Green Fund Project</i> (with Queen W., Holland S., Addai, N.B., & Willis K.) [Link]
GRANTS	Green Fund Modelling Energy Consumption II — \$9,720 May 2021 - August 2021 Modelling Energy Consumption I — \$11,232 May 2020 - August 2020
HONORS & AWARDS	UNC Dissertation Fellowship (\$24,000) 2026 - 2027 Joseph M. Kampf and the Elizabeth & Harry Brainard Scholarship (\$21,700) 2021 Data Dive Hackathon - 2nd Runner-up , Arch MI (\$2,000) 2021 Joseph M. Bryan Foundation Scholarship, UNCG (\$26,000) 2020 - 2021 BB&T Academic Excellence Fellow, UNCG (\$6,000) 2019 Bryan Sch of Business and Economics - Academic Excellence Medal 2020

MEMBERSHIP	American Economic Association, Southern Economic Association, Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management, Kathleen Price & Joseph M. Bryan Fellow	
OTHER	Co-founder, QuantBridge webinar series	
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Graduate Program Ambassador, Bryan Sch of Business and Economics i-Ambassador, International Student Rep, UNCG	
REFeree SERVICE	<i>Review of Development Economics, BMC Public Health</i>	
SKILLS	Stata, R, SAS, MATLAB, Fortran	
TOOLS	L ^A T _E X, GitHub, Microsoft office	
REFERENCES	Donna Gilleskie Edwin Averyt Poston Distinguished Professor University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill donna_gilleskie@unc.edu Michelle Sheran-Andrews Teaching Professor of Economics University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill mesheran@email.unc.edu	Jane Cooley Fruehwirth Professor of Economics University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill jane_fruehwirth@unc.edu